"If you keep staring at the wax, it’s not going to apply itself," Michelangelo said, leaning over his shoulder.

The workshop was small and smelled of old rubber and industrial solvent. It was the kind of place where things were repaired by necessity rather than art, filled with stacks of mismatched tires and half-empty cans of sealant. A single, flickering fluorescent bulb hummed overhead, casting a jittery light over a workbench cluttered with precision tools and various grades of sandpaper. In the center of the chaos sat a pair of skis, their bases being meticulously smoothed by a very large, very green hand.

Gandalf didn’t look up from the skis, though his long, silver beard was currently dangerously close to a puddle of high-performance glide wax. "Precision is the sibling of success, Michelangelo. If the base is not perfectly planar, we shall find ourselves spinning like tops upon the first descent."

"Dude, it’s a mountain, not a math test," Mikey replied, tossing a small piece of sandpaper into the air and catching it. He looked over at the other side of the room, where Leonardo was obsessively checking the straps on a snowboard, his expression one of intense, disciplined focus.

"You’re overthinking the straps, Leo," Donatello called out from the corner, where he was currently tinkering with a set of modified goggles. He had spent the last hour integrating a GPS overlay into the lenses, a project he claimed was for 'safety' but was clearly just for the sake of gadgetry. "Unless you plan on snowboarding through a dimensional rift, those bindings are more than secure enough."

Leonardo didn't even blink, his fingers tightening the ratchet with a satisfying *click*. "Preparation is the difference between a graceful carve and a very public face-plant, Donnie. Especially when we're skiing with a wizard."

The door to the workshop creaked open, admitting a blast of frigid air and the towering figure of Gimli, whose boots sounded like small hammers hitting the concrete floor. He was carrying a set of custom-made skis that looked more like miniature sleigh runners, carved from a dense, dark wood and reinforced with steel edges. "Is the tinkering finished?" he bellowed, his voice echoing off the low ceiling. "The peaks of the White Mountains do not wait for the indecision of turtles and wizards!"

"Almost there, Gimli!" Mikey shouted, finally stepping away from the workbench. He looked at his own gear—a neon-orange snowboard that practically glowed in the dim light. "I’m just saying, if we actually hit a dimensional rift, I’m the one who’s going to be dressed for the occasion."

The transition from the dim, solvent-scented workshop to the summit of the White Mountains happened in a blur of shimmering light and a sudden, violent drop in temperature. One moment

they were arguing over the merits of neon orange; the next, they were standing on a precipice of blinding white, the air so crisp it felt like inhaling shards of glass.

"Now this," Gimli announced, planting his heavy skis into the crust of the snow with a definitive thud, "is a proper greeting!"